1. *Theory of theory:* how ‘scientific’ the discipline of IR can become.
2. *Systems analysis:* This refers to the development of hypotheses about the international system. The two primary foci are the state as a responding unit within the international system and the configuration of the international system on the whole.
3. *Action theories:* the analysis of the ways states and their decision makers conduct foreign policy including decision-making capabilities, institutions and the interaction of the political system and national society.
4. *Interaction theory:* which attempts to generalize about the ‘patterns’ of interactions and the internal behaviour of the interacting units like the theory of balance of power, world equilibrium, gaming, “challenge and response”, international processes involving competition, cooperation, bargaining and conflict.
5. *Newer research techniques:* borrowed from other disciplines; content analysis borrowed from the study of communications, psychometrics useful in measuring such attitudes as ‘friendship’ or ‘hostility’ among states, game theory and the like.[28]

Several alternative approaches have also developed into the study of contemporary IR.

1. Post-modernist theories propounded by Richard Ashley (1988), R.B.J. Walker (1993), James Derian (1989) and others.
2. Critical theories advocated by Andrew Linklater (1990), Robert Cox (1996) and others.
3. Historical sociology propounded by Michael Mann (1986 and 1983), Charles Tilly (1990), Theda Skocpol.
4. Feminist theories advocated by J. Ann Tickner (1988), Cynthis Enloe (1988, 1990, 1993 and 1999) and Christine Sylvester (1998).[29]

Despite such breakthroughs in theory building and paradigm development and improvisations, IR is difficult to study by utilizing such theories. At best, a mixture of combination of theories is required to obtain acceptable results. The aim is to provide the IR